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General Comment

The conversation around AI and it's role in our daily lives is embarrassing. I work in the creative industries as a comics editor and writer. I come across copyright every day in my work--from acquiring titles and filing copyrights with creators, to making sure that copyrights are printed correctly on work for the sake of individuals and companies, to having to know what exists under copyright and what is already in the public domain. It is a huge part of my livelihood. And as a creator myself, it is massively important that the things I make remain under the copyright laws we have now.

Generative AI has done nothing to benefit anyone. The companies that're chasing it, like OpenAI, have yet to post a profit--because AI doesn't make money. They've also said that they won't make a profit, unless they're allowed to dismantle our copyright system for their training. Good. There's no reason for their business to exist. It doesn't work with the law as it is. The AI companies have either openly, or in the process of many legal proceedings already, admitted to intellectual property theft. Many systems have had to be shut down for giving misleading information--both the inconvenient, like systems that were practically giving away cars, and the dangerous, that provided inaccurate and harmful medical information. Consumer trust goes down when AI are added to systems, in large part due to the inaccuracies.

Simply put, our AI Action Plan should be complete divestment. America doesn't need to be the leader in a scam that, again, so far doesn't even accomplish it's goal of making the wealthy wealthier. To develop a plan to infringe upon copyright, privacy, and the interests of businesses both large and small is shameful.